LESSON 11

Present Continuous

We use the Present Continuous to talk about:

- things that are happening at the time when we speak

John **is** writ**ing** his homework.

We **are** watch**ing** a film now.

Are you listen**ing** to me?

- changes that are happening around now

The number of graduate students **is** grow**ing** rapidly.

I **am** read**ing** a good book these days.

My friends **are** build**ing** their own house.

Time expressions often used with the Present Continuous: *at the moment, now, today, this morning/ afternoon/ year, these days.*

Formation rules: **am/are/is + V-ing** (Also see the tables below.)

Affirmative: e.g. Laura **is** read**ing** all day. My friends **are** wait**ing** for me.

Negative: e.g. Laura **is not** (**isn't**) read**ing** all day. My friends **are not** (**aren't**) waiting for me.

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Interrogative: e.g. **Is** Laura read**ing** all day? **Are** my friends wait**ing** for me?

NOTE: some short verbs double their last letter before the *-ing* ending. E.g. chat – chatting, beg – begging, drop – dropping.

Affirmative

I	am	studying Writing Skills this semester.
He/She/(It)	is	
We You They	are	

Negative

I	am not (’m not)	studying Writing Skills this semester.
He/She/(It)	is not (isn’t)	
We You They	are not (aren’t)	

Interrogative

Am	I	studying Writing Skills this semester?
Is	he/she/(it)	
Are	we you they	

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